Epidermal Outgrowths

There are many types of epidermal outgrowths in stems. The unicellular or multicellular appendages that originate from the epidermal cells are called **trichomes**. Trichomes may be branched or unbranched and are one or more one celled thick. They assume many shapes and sizes. They may also be glandular (Example: *Rose, Ocimum*) or non-glandular.



The trichomes on the leaves of insectivorous plants secrete mucopolysaccharides that trap insects.

Piliferous layer of the root has two types of epidermal cells, long cells and short cells. The short cells are called **trichoblasts**. Trichoblasts are elongate into root hairs. Epidermal hairs can also be in the form of stellate hairs (star shaped) present in plants. Example: styrax, many members of Malvaceae and Solanaceae.

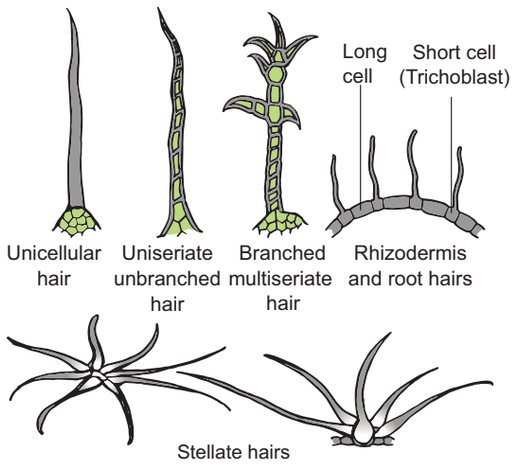


Figure 9.13: Types of Trichomes

Prickles

Prickles, are one type of epidermal emergences with no vascular supply. They are stiff and sharp in appearance. (Example: Rose).



Figure 9.14: Prickles

Functions of Epidermal Tissue System

1. This system in the shoot checks excessive loss of water due to the presence of cuticle.
2. Epidermis protects the underlying tissues.
3. Stomata is involved in transpiration and gaseous exchange.
4. Trichomes are also helpful in the dispersal of seeds and fruits, and provide protection against animals.
5. Prickles also provide protection against animals and they also check excessive transpiration
6. In some rose plants they also help in climbing.
7. Glandular hairs repel herbivorous animals.

9.5 Fundamental Tissue System

The ground or fundamental tissue system constitutes the main body of the plants. It includes all the tissues except epidermis and vascular tissues. In monocot stem, ground tissue system is a continuous mass of parenchymatous tissue in which vascular bundles are found scattered. Hence ground tissue is not differentiated into cortex, endodermis, pericycle and pith. Generally in dicot stem, ground tissue system is differentiated into three main zones – cortex, pericycle and pith. It is classified into extrastelar ground tissue (Examples: cortex and endodermis) and intrastelar ground tissue (Examples: pericycle, medullary ray and pith)

Extrastelar Ground Tissue

The ground tissues present outside the stele is called extrastelar ground tissue. (Cortex)

Intrastelar Ground Tissue

The ground tissues present within the stele are called intrastelar ground tissues. (pericycle, medullary rays and pith).

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